

MICHAELA VIVIENNE SANTIAGO

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Portfolio: <https://miavies.github.io/github-portfolio/>

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Creative and technically skilled game developer with practical experience in Unity, C# scripting, asset integration and animation, and QA debugging. Proven track record includes multiple Best Work recognition in core game production projects, runner-up at CIIT Game Jam 2026, and participant in PGDX 2025. A consistent Dean's List student with an analytical engineering background and strong foundations in game design principles, applied mathematics and physics in games, gameplay logic, and UI workflows, enabling the development of polished, deployment-ready game systems and mechanics.

CORE SKILLS & COMPETENCIES

Technical Skills

- **Programming Languages:** C#, Java, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, C++, BASIC
- **Developer Tools & Version Control:** GitHub, MS Visual Studio, Visual Studio Code, Arduino, MS Visual Basic
- **Game Engines & 3D Design Software:** Unity, AutoCAD, Blender
- **2D Design Software:** Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Clip Studio Paint, Aseprite, Canva
- **Audio Design Software:** Adobe Audition
- **Video Editing Software:** Adobe Premier Pro
- **Website Builder:** Duda
- **Office Document Tools:** MS Office, Google Workspace, Zoho Workplace

Soft Skills

- Excellent written and verbal communication skills in English and Filipino
- Interpersonal skills with a people-first approach while achieving objectives
- Effective independent and collaborative team player
- Strong organizational, time management, and multitasking skills
- Leadership and project coordination skills
- Proactive and empathetic mindset
- Adaptability to diverse workflows, processes, and client requirements
- Open-minded perspective on game design and player preferences
- Strong problem-solving and critical-thinking abilities
- High attention to detail
- Strong digital drawing fundamentals
- Creativity and innovation
- Mechanical design and evaluation capabilities

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Consistent Dean's List student (Current GPA: 3.89) and recipient of the Gold Weave Award for ranking among the top 1to 10 students on the Dean's List
- First runner-up at CIIT Global Game Jam 2026
- Chosen for Best Work for the following academic projects:
 - Tusok at Tiyaga (game) – Game Production Process
 - Deep Space Tavern (game) – Game Programming 3
 - Death’s Brew (game) – Game Programming 2
 - Monster Market Madness (game) – Game Programming 1
 - Portfolio website – Information Management
 - Digital drawing – Free Hand and Digital Drawing
- Participant in PGDX 2025
- Designed and built the Examiners Edge website and implemented SEO strategies, establishing its online presence, and contributing to increased client acquisition

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Unity UI/UX Designer and Programmer – PDEA, Quezon City (May – June 2026)**
 - Integration and connection of UI assets to scripts
 - Design and creation of needed UI assets
 - Configuration of panels, buttons, toggles, scroll view, input fields, images, menus, pop-ups, and other UI elements
 - Creation, testing and debugging, quality assurance, and bug fixing of scripts
- **Project Engineer – Examiners Edge, Duncanville, Texas (May 2024 – April 2026)**
 - Developed educational courses and training materials on U.S. trademarks, patents, and intellectual property processes for professional audiences.
 - Managed project tasks, conducted research, organized data using Excel, and prepared reports to support operational efficiency and decision-making.
 - Designed presentations, marketing materials, educational storybooks, and other visual assets to support branding, outreach, and learning initiatives.
 - Developed and maintained company websites, implemented SEO strategies, and created Learning Management System (LMS) content to improve online visibility and educational delivery.
 - Produced and edited digital content, including documents, images, videos, and other multimedia assets aligned with project objectives.
 - Created USPTO-compliant AutoCAD patent drawings for inventors filing provisional and non-provisional utility patent applications.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (continuation)

- **Freelance Video Editor – Quezon City (March 2023 - Present)**
 - Focused on creating interesting and enticing audio-visual presentations of scientific research projects for information dissemination and to gain popularity among potential buyers and/or investors
- **Freelance Digital Artist/ Graphic Artist – Quezon City (January 2019 - Present)**
 - Focused on creating digital paintings, logos, packaging designs, character designs, backgrounds
- **University Research Associate II – BIOMECH, UP, Los Baños (Mar – Aug 2023)**
- **Junior Project Assistant – AMTEC, UP, Los Baños (Jan – Jun 2022)**
- **Junior Engineering Assistant – AMTEC, UP, Los Baños (Mar 2020 - Dec 2021)**
- **Research Assistant– AMTEC, UP, Los Baños (Mar - Aug 2019)**

EDUCATION

- **BS in Entertainment and Multimedia Computing – CIIT College of Innovation and Integrated Technology, Quezon City (Expected Graduation Date: April 2027)**
 - Relevant Course Work: Artificial Intelligence for Game Dev, Web Programming, Software Quality Engineering, Free Hand and Digital Drawing, Computer Graphics Programming, Usability, HCI, UI Design, Audio Design and Sound Engineering, Scriptwriting and Storyboard Design, Game Design and Production Process, Applied Mathematics and Physics for Games, Game Programming, Game Networking, 2D Animation, 3D Animation
- **BS in Agricultural and Biosystems Engineering – University of the Philippines, Los Baños (July 2013 – July 2019)**
 - Relevant Course Work: Introduction to Computer Programming

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAININGS

- **AI Engineering Workshop for Game Development – CIIT (June 27, 2026)**
- **Crafting of a Compelling Story: Techniques for Animation and Film – CIIT (November 7, 2024)**
- **Creative Chronicles: Writing for Games (November 13, 2023)**
- **Principles of Graphic Design – University of the Philippines Open University, Los Baños (February - March 2023)**
- **Agricultural and Biosystems Engineering Board Passer (October 2019)**

ORGANIZATION

- **An officer under the marketing and creatives division of UnPAUSE– Union of Production, Art, User Experience, Sound, and Entertainment – the official Game Development student organization of CIIT**
- **Actively creates publication materials and assists with the organization of UnPAUSE events such as hosting the Global Game Jam.**